→Homo Sapiens, ~~a genus~~ a species of hominid originating in Southern Africa a few hundred thousand years ago, has, for the past 20,000 years or so, proliferated across the globe, spreading to all seven continents and largely changing the ecosystem of wherever its members went. From the definition of an invasive species, which is an organism that spreads rapidly in a non-native environment and causes havoc in said environment, one may define Homo Sapiens to be a kind of invasive species. However, are these species necessarily bad? Utilizing the information in Documents 1, 2, 3, and 4, one will be forced to come to the conclusion that it is unnecessary to control invasive populations due to the difficulty of doing so, potential of invasive organisms to help the environment, and present fearmongering regarding these organisms.

~~In Document 2 the~~ Firstly, the cost of erasing these organisms is, oftentimes, not worth the ~~risk of~~ limited reward of removing the organism. Take the list of various methods of eradication mentioned in Document 2, such as the use of biological weapons of disease, chemical sprays, and even the introduction of another invasive species (Source 2, lines 36-44). This list does not sound minimally invasive [redacted] by any means. It reads more like a list of war crimes than simply removal of pests. The potential damage to the environment from these methods are usually more than that of the original problem, especially in the case of introducing another species. At best, scientists are swapping out one invader with another, at worst the new invader doesn't control the original, and the ecosystem now has compounded problems. → onto next page

Another such example of this risky gamble is mentioned briefly in ~~Document~~ Source 3, where the author speaks of the introduction of a virus to control rabbit populations practically eradicating a large blue butterfly species (Source 3, lines 30-31). In this case, the assumed result of introducing a new species to combat an invasive one plays out to full negative effect. Now the British ecosystem ~~no~~ has to deal with the consequences of the excess rabbit population and the loss of the butterfly, which could have been avoided had officials let the rabbits be. Ultimately, the risks of removing an invasive species once imbedded in the local ecosystem is equal to that of removing a tumor from a patient's aorta.

Not only is it potentially harmful to remove invasive species due to the adverse affects of the methods, but also because some invasive species may have beneficial affects in the environment. This is exemplified wonderfully in ~~the~~ Source 1 in the opening anecdote about the Asian Honeysuckle. The plant, which was assumed to be harmful, actually turned out to be to the benefit of the environment since it attracted native birds to come eat the native fruits and thereby spread the seeds of native plants (Source 1, lines 5-12). In this case, the honeysuckle actually aids the native species in reproduction, vitalizing the environment in a novel manner. A similar example can be found within Source 4, which outlines that plant populations double in biological diversity following an invasion of an Oceanic island (Source 4, lines 41-43). In this instance, again the potential for beneficial environmental affects from the introduction of an invasive species is made strikingly obvious. Assuming that species diversity and

radiation are positive indicators in determing the state of an ecosystem, the ecosystem was improved, not hindered, on these oceanic islands. It is strikingly clear that, although not always, invasive species do have the potential to benefit an environment.

Finally, the dangers of invasive species are often over emphasized. Even the name "invasive" seems hostile. Some may argue that this is simply a reflection of the nature of these organisms, however, this is an unfounded assertion. In Source 3, the author introduces the concept of "invasion" biology by stating organisms "invade" geographical regions while simultaneously stating that most "invasions" fail (Source 3, lines 1-10). If these invasive species where as much of a massive problem as the author makes ~~it~~ them out to be, then it would be assumed that most invasions at least succeed. If anything, it seems these events happen via chance, and a chance of low probability at that. In addition, the author of Source 4 points out that biologists tend to characterize these organisms as if they are intentionally staging an offensive (Source 4, lines 1-19). These organisms obviously are not intentionally doing this, spreading themselves across the globe, we did this. Most would argue others shouldn't pay for the mistakes of others, so morally we shouldn't really be killing these organisms because we messed up. Essentially the severity of the issue is largely exaggerated by scientists to justify the amoral eradication of innocent living beings.

In summary, the eradication of invasive species is a fear-mongered solution ~~tha~~ to an issue that really isn't that much of an issue since the organisms in question ~~aren't that harmful~~ are oftentimes beneficial to the environment and the cost of

removal is too great. Eradicating these organisms may be the greatest hypocrisy ever known, as we, ourselves, Homo Sapiens, are ourselves invasive species. What would give us the right to do this to a fellow invader? Most upon reviewing the evidence that nothing would give us this right.